IT'S NOT YOU. IT'S CLAUDE.

This guide builds the 80-second horizontal film (1920x1080) that plays inside the laptop. The 12-second vertical version in the Reel Studio library is a separate short edit of it, see step 05. The long film has: a fall through a tunnel of 9,000 cubes, chrome letters with real physics, a chain, liquid metal, 50,000 particles, and a laptop shot where a letter falls out of the screen. No After Effects. From install to a finished mp4. Windows and Mac.



WHAT YOU GET

A motion reel where every letter, every light, every camera move and every sound is code. You describe it in words. Claude builds the 3D world, moves the camera, writes the music and renders the file. Then you put it on a laptop in a dark room, like a screen recording.

0	9K	50K	3
EDITING APPS OPENED	CUBES IN THE TUNNEL	PARTICLES IN ONE SCENE	VERSIONS TO GET HERE

What you need

- A Windows 10/11 or macOS computer. A graphics card helps. A weak laptop works too, just slower.
- A Claude plan that includes Claude Code.
- A voice: your own recording or a text-to-speech tool you are allowed to use. A tool that understands emotion tags like [laughs] makes a big difference.
- For the laptop shot: a photo of a laptop with a green screen. Shoot your own or generate one.

> **Honest part.** The first version was flat cards on an orange-and-black background. It looked cheap and I said so. The second was real 3D but too calm. The third is what you see. All my notes are in this guide, you can send them to Claude as they are.

FOUR RULES THAT MADE IT

01 · Reference first
Take a reel you love and let Claude break it down frame by frame before you build anything

02 · Real 3D
Chrome, glass, light and physics in three.js. Flat cards on a background always look cheap

03 · The voice drives it
Every event lands on the word that names it: "drop it" and the letters fall

04 · Two hooks
One in the first second, one in the middle. The fake crash keeps people to the end

Why it holds attention

Something changes every two or three seconds: a new place, a new material, a new joke. The voice reacts like a real person ("oh no", "wait, wait, wait"), so the viewer reacts with him.

What makes it look expensive

One neon colour, not five. Chrome that reflects light strips. A dark glossy floor with real reflections. Tiny mono labels in the corners. Flashes only on big moments.

> **Reel Studio buyers:** skip this section. The folder name, the install and the first Claude launch below are the steps I took when I built this reel on a clean computer. You already work in `My-Reel-Studio`, so open it and start from `FIRST-REEL.md`.

INSTALL THE TOOLS

1 Open a terminal

WINDOWS Press Win, type `PowerShell`, open it.

MAC Press Cmd + Space, type `Terminal`, open it.

2 Node.js, Git, Python and ffmpeg

WINDOWS Paste one line at a time. Answer `Y` when asked.

POWERSHELL

```
winget install -e --id OpenJS.NodeJS.LTS
winget install -e --id Git.Git
winget install -e --id Python.Python.3.13
winget install -e --id Gyan.FFmpeg
```

MAC Homebrew first, it will ask for your password. At the end it prints two lines under “Next steps”: run them, then run the second command.

TERMINAL · STEP 1

```
/bin/bash -c "$(curl -fsSL
https://raw.githubusercontent.com/Homebrew/install/HEAD/ins
tall.sh)"
```

TERMINAL · STEP 2

```
brew install node git python ffmpeg
```

> Important. Close the terminal and open it again after installing, or it will not see the new programs.

3 Claude Code

TERMINAL

```
npm install -g @anthropic-ai/claude-code
```

Prefer an app to a terminal? Install Claude from claude.ai/download, it has a Code tab that does the same thing.

FOLDER AND FIRST PROMPTS

1 Create a folder and start Claude

TERMINAL

```
mkdir motion-reel\ncd motion-reel\nclaude
```

2 Setup

PROMPT · SETUP

```
Set up a 3D motion project in this folder.

1. Install Remotion (React 18 + TypeScript) with
@remotion/three, three and @react-three/fiber.
2. Check that Python has numpy installed, plus faster-whisper
for checking voice files. Install what is missing.
3. Check that ffmpeg works from the terminal.
4. Build a test composition, 1920x1080, 30 fps: one chrome
sphere in three.js on a black background, lit by an
environment map, with a bloom pass (UnrealBloomPass). Render
one frame to PNG with the GL backend set to "angle" and show
me the path.

If something is missing, install it yourself and tell me what
you installed. If something fails, find the cause and fix it.
```

3 Break down your reference

PROMPT · REFERENCE

```
Here is a reference reel: [path to the video].
Break it down before we build anything:
1. Pull frames every 2 seconds and look at them at full size.
2. Transcribe the voice.
3. Write me a list: what makes it look expensive (light,
materials, colour, camera, small details), what the hook is
and why it works, how the voice talks about what is on screen.
We will not copy it. We take the level and make our own story.
```

4 The voice

Generate these lines with a text-to-speech tool that understands emotion tags, or record them yourself. One line per file, two takes each, put them in the folder.

VOICE LINES

```
Write one voice-over line per file. Male, 25-35, American
English, alive and warm, with humour. Like a guy showing a
friend his laptop at 3 a.m.: surprised, laughing, unsure,
sometimes whispering. Speed about 1.15. The tags in square
brackets are emotions, not words:
1. [gasps] Wait… who's texting me at 3 a.m.?
2. [reading, deadpan] "Bro. That's your forty-seventh 'make it
better' tonight."
3. [laughs] Okay, fair. But look what it built...
4. [shouting, laughing] Whoa, whoa... where are we going?!
5. [excited] What is happening?!
6. [breathless] Okay… okay, I think we're landing.
7. Oh. Of course. [your word].
8. No After Effects. No timeline. Just code.
9. Watch. "Stretch it." [chuckles] That's a lot of letter.
10. "Drop it." Oh no. [laughs]
11. "Put it back." … Boom.
12. [confident] "Now make it a chain."
13. [hesitant] Wait, wait, wait… how?
14. It's not a video. It's code. Every letter, every light,
every camera move.
15. Still keyframing in Blender? [sighs] Respect.
16. Liquid metal? Done.
17. Fifty thousand particles? Easy.
18. Glass. Gold. Midnight.
19. [panicked] No, no, no... did it crash?!
20. [laughs] Kidding.
21. Every video on my page? Made exactly like this.
22. And yeah… you can do this for your brand.
23. Comment "[CODEWORD]", and I'll show you how.
```

THE REEL BRIEF

Replace what is in square brackets with your own word, colour, videos and handle. The rest can stay.

Which reel is this? The brief below makes the 80-second horizontal film. The 12-second vertical reel in the library is a short cut of it that opens on the laptop. Make the long film first, then use the 12-second prompt in step 05.

PROMPT · REEL BRIEF

Build a 3D motion reel in three.js inside Remotion. 1920x1080, 30 fps, about 80 seconds, H.264 CRF 18, yuv420p. All text in English.

LOOK
Black void. One neon accent with a soft glow: [acid lime #B6FF2E]. White chrome letters with a bevel (TextGeometry from a heavy wide font), lit by an environment map made of softboxes and thin neon strips, so highlights run across the chrome. A glossy dark floor with a real mirror reflection (Reflector) under a semi-transparent matte film. Bloom on, but chrome must stay sharp: only the neon glows. Small technical labels in the corners in a mono font: handle, frame counter, scene name. No flat cards, no stickers, no orange-black by default.

ONE WORLD, ONE CAMERA
Everything lives in one 3D space. The camera flies on a Catmull-Rom spline through keyframes, with a slight handheld drift. A cut is only allowed under a flash.

VOICE DRIVES THE PICTURE
I give you one audio file per line. Transcribe them with word timestamps and place every event on the word that names it: "Stretch it" stretches, "Drop it" drops, "Boom" lands. When I give Claude a command on screen, show it typed in a small command bar at the bottom with a send button.

SCENES
1. HOOK. A glossy black phone in lime light. Lock screen at 3:07 with a message from [Claude]: "[Bro. That's your 47th 'make it better' tonight.]" The camera orbits and pushes in.
2. THE FALL. The camera dives into the phone screen, flash, and falls down a tunnel. First the tunnel is made of thousands of thin glowing lines (warp speed), then it rebuilds into walls of cubes (instanced, about 9,000) with colour waves running through them: lime, magenta, cyan, gold. Chrome letters tumble down next to us.
3. LANDING. Out of the tunnel the letters overtake the camera and slam onto the floor as [CLAUDE]. Shockwave ring on the floor.
4. RUBBER. "Stretch it": every letter stretches like rubber, then one letter stretches across the whole screen.
5. GRAVITY. "Drop it": real falling with bounces and tipping over (simulate it in code, deterministic). "Put it back": play the simulation backwards like a rewind, "Boom".

6. CHAIN. "Now make it a chain": the letters fly up and turn into chrome links that hook into a swinging chain.
7. UNDER THE HOOD. The camera flies through one link into an x-ray: chrome becomes wireframe with neon edges, lines of code appear, dimension lines, a grid on the floor.
8. BLENDER JOKE. The grey default cube with an orange outline and a little keyframe timeline. On "Respect" it shatters into glowing cubes.
9. LIQUID METAL. The letters melt into a chrome blob that ripples (icosphere with noise).
10. PARTICLES. 50,000 points: blob surface, then a spinning galaxy, then they land on the surface of the letters and the letters come back.
11. MATERIALS. "Glass. Gold. Midnight": the letters switch material on each word, each look with its own light.
12. SECOND HOOK. "Did it crash?": the frame freezes, glitch bars, a red "Render failed · Out of memory" window. "Kidding": the window shatters.
13. MY WORK. A corridor of floating screens with my reels: [paths to my videos]. The camera flies through it.
14. FINAL. The letters flip one by one into [MOTION]. A small "COMMENT" label above. Then one letter rolls toward the camera and drops out of the bottom of the frame.

SOUND
Write the music in numpy, no samples: a dark tech-house groove around 128 BPM that drops in when we land, a riser and hi-hats in the tunnel, a sound for every event (rubber boing, metal clanks, rewind, glass chime, gold shimmer, glitch). Cut the music dead during the fake crash. Duck the music under the voice. Master to -14 LUFS.

WORKFLOW
1. Type-check must pass.
2. Render a storyboard: one frame every 40 frames in one sheet. Look at it yourself at full size.
3. Fix: blown-out bloom, empty frames, text over text, objects out of frame. Re-render.
4. Render the final with sound. If the browser crashes on a weak computer, render in chunks of 400 frames in a fresh browser each time and join them with ffmpeg.
5. Check the frame-to-frame difference with ffmpeg (tblend + signalstats). Every spike must be a planned flash.
6. Tell me: file path, what you checked, what you could not check.

Do not stop until there is a finished mp4.

PUT IT ON A LAPTOP

This is what makes people stop: it looks like someone filmed a laptop in a dark room. First the photo, then the brief.

● IMAGE PROMPT · LAPTOP PHOTO

```
Photorealistic vertical photo, like it was shot on a phone at
night. A dark room. An open laptop, dark grey aluminium, no
logo, on a dark desk, shot from the front-left at about 3/4,
slightly from above. The screen takes 60-70% of the frame
width. Behind the laptop a lamp throws a bright, soft spot of
acid-lime light (#B6FF2E) on the wall. The keyboard backlight
is faint and white. The screen is a flat, evenly lit pure
green #00FF00, no interface, all four corners clearly visible.
Free desk surface in front of the laptop. Slight grain,
shallow depth of field, honest reflections on the aluminium.
No people, no hands, no text.
```

PROMPT · LAPTOP SHOT

Now put the finished reel on that laptop. Vertical 1080x1920.

1. Find the four corners of the green screen precisely: fit straight lines to the four edges of the green area and intersect them. Do not use the extreme pixels, the corners are rounded.
2. Map the 1920x1080 reel onto the screen with a perspective transform (homography as CSS matrix3d). Add a faint glass reflection and the screen light spilling onto the keyboard.
3. Crop the photo so the laptop fills the width and there is room above it for one line of text: "[I made this with Claude Code. No After Effects.]"
4. Handheld camera: a slow drift. At the start the focus hunts for a second, then the sound of a space bar and the reel starts.
5. At the end, at the exact frame where the letter rolls out of the bottom of the reel, a real 3D chrome letter flies out of that corner of the laptop screen, falls on the laptop with 3-4 bounces and settles. Match its camera to the photo pixels so it sits in the picture. A soft shadow under it.
6. The camera zooms in on the letter in two handheld jerks, focus misses for a moment. Voice: "[Oh... oops. Okay… Claude, we're fixing that.]" Metal clank on every bounce, quieter each time.
7. Render a few frames from the start, the middle and the end, check them, then the final.

PROMPT · THE 12-SECOND VERTICAL VERSION

Make a 12-second vertical cut of the finished reel, 1080x1920, 30 fps, with my voice line. Do not render a new film.

1. From the first frame a chrome CLAUDE fills the screen. The camera pulls back and it is the laptop screen.
2. The letters fall out of the screen onto the keyboard and slide out of the bottom of the frame.
3. The screen bursts into the tunnel, then play the best moments of the long reel about twice as fast: the chain, the liquid metal, the particles.
4. Short captions of my own, no blur and no shake. Light in the room changes colour per scene.
5. Show a storyboard of real frames first and wait for my yes.

HOW TO FIX IT WITH NOTES

The first render is never the final one. Watch it and say what is wrong. These are close to the notes I actually sent:

IT LOOKS CHEAP

It looks simple and cheap, nothing like the reference. Stop using orange and black everywhere. Look at how the reference is made: real 3D, chrome, one neon colour, light. Make it expensive.

THE HOOK IS WEAK

The hook is not a hook. I want a surprise and a joke in the first seconds, like someone unexpected texting me. Then show the wow right away.

THE VOICE IS FLAT

I want a male voice with emotions: sighs, laughs, 'wait, wait', doubt. It should talk about what is happening on screen right now.

MORE DOPAMINE

Make it more dynamic. Add a tunnel: first made of lines, then of cubes, different colours, and make it longer. The voice asks where we are falling. The letters fall and assemble into a different word.

SHOW MORE

Show more of what Claude can do: a chain made of the letters, liquid metal, particles. Add one more hook in the middle. Show all my videos.

A LETTER LOOKS BROKEN

Something is wrong with the letter M, it has a dark wedge on it. Find out why and fix it.

WHAT BROKE FOR ME

- **A dark wedge on the M.** The font had overlapping outlines, and 3D text draws them as a broken face. Removing the overlaps in the font file (fontTools) fixed it.
- **A white tunnel.** Bloom plus bright lines turned the whole frame white. Less glow and darker colours brought the depth back.
- **Black video screens.** Videos as textures inside the 3D scene rendered black. Putting them on a layer above the 3D, as image frames, fixed it.
- **The render died at 60%.** On my laptop the browser page crashed with this many objects. Rendering in chunks of 400 frames, each in a fresh browser, and joining them fixed it.
- **Claude cannot hear or see motion.** It checks still frames and numbers. How the reel feels is yours to judge, so expect several rounds.
- **Slow render.** A heavy 3D reel can take an hour on a weak laptop. It is normal.

COMMON QUESTIONS

Will I get the same reel?

Similar in structure, not frame for frame: Claude writes the code from scratch each time. Change the word, the colour and the jokes to make it yours.

Do I need to know three.js?

No. You need to know what you want to see and say it clearly. Claude writes the code.

The terminal shows a red error. Now what?

Copy it and paste it to Claude with the words “here is the error, fix it and continue”.

09 · NEXT @VERONIIXX.AI

BUILT YOURS? SHOW ME

Tag @veroniixx.ai and I will share it in stories.